

JANUARY

2026 V 1.0

RE4U REBUTTAL LETTER TEMPLATE

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Rebuttal Letter Template

Template | DOCX

A point-by-point response format that helps scholars reply clearly, respectfully, and efficiently to editors and reviewers.

How to use this sample: Edit the highlighted placeholders, adapt the tone to your journal, and verify every factual statement before submission.

When this template is useful

- You received reviewer comments and need a clean response structure.
- You want polite, editor-friendly language without sounding defensive.
- You need a reusable format for minor revision, major revision, or resubmission.

Suggested response flow

Section	What to include
Opening note to editor	Thank the editor, state the manuscript title and ID, and confirm that all comments were addressed carefully.
Reviewer 1 response	Reply comment by comment. Quote or summarise each comment and then explain the revision made.
Reviewer 2 response	Use the same structure for consistency and easy checking.
Tracked revision note	Mention whether changes are marked in track changes or highlighted in the revised manuscript.

Editable template

[Date]

Dear Editor,

Thank you for the opportunity to revise our manuscript, titled “[Insert Manuscript Title]” (Manuscript ID: [Insert ID]). We appreciate the time and effort invested by you and the reviewers. We have revised the manuscript carefully and addressed each comment point by point below. All changes in the revised manuscript have been [highlighted / marked using track changes].

Sincerely,

[Corresponding Author Name]

[Affiliation and email]

Reviewer 1

Comment 1: [Paste or summarise the reviewer's comment here.]

Response: Thank you for this helpful comment. We have revised the manuscript accordingly by [briefly explain action]. The updated text appears in [section/page/line number].

Change made in manuscript: “[Insert revised sentence or short summary of revision.]”

Comment 2: [Paste or summarise the reviewer's comment here.]

Response: We appreciate this observation. After careful consideration, we have [made the suggested change / clarified our rationale / respectfully retained the original approach because...]. To improve clarity, we added [specific explanation] in [section/page/line number].

Useful response phrases

Purpose	Sample wording
Acknowledging a valid point	We thank the reviewer for this insightful comment and have revised the manuscript accordingly.
Clarifying rather than changing	We agree that this point required clearer explanation and have now clarified this in the revised manuscript.
Respectful disagreement	We respectfully note that implementing this change would alter the study scope; however, we have clarified this limitation explicitly.
Pointing to location	The relevant revision has been added to the Methods section on page [X], lines [Y–Z].

THANK YOU

REVIEWER RESPONSE SUPPORT

We help researchers strengthen
comment-wise responses • revision logic • respectful disagreement • response
clarity • editor-ready presentation

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